

NEXT <> Codebase Project Scope

Purpose

The main idea is to replace an existing matching service with a new web app that helps mentees find mentors in relevant fields and receive structured resources leading up to meetings. The system should make it easy for staff to onboard students/mentors, generate a match, and automate weekly email communications that support each session.

Goals

Functional goals

- Enable students (new or existing) to be matched to an appropriate mentor using simple, explainable criteria (e.g., field of interest, university).
- Enable staff/admins to manage a lightweight database of students, mentors, matches, and upcoming sessions.
- Send weekly email notifications that include meeting resources (and optionally logistics) to the student and mentor.

Secondary goals

- Make the experience accessible and low-friction (simple UI, minimal steps).
 - Provide an audit trail: staff can see who is matched, when, and what emails were sent.
-

Users & roles

Student

- Creates a profile
- Specifies interests (field), university, optional preferences
- Sees their mentor match + upcoming session info (MVP can be minimal)

Mentor

- Creates a profile
- Specifies field(s), university, availability notes
- Sees who they're matched to and session/resource info

Admin / Program Staff

- Runs matching
 - Upload session curriculum
-

MVP features

A) Authentication & access

- Admin login (required)
- Mentor/student login

B) Profile management (CRUD)

Student profile

- Name, email
- Field(s) of interest (dropdown/tags)
- University (dropdown/free text with normalization)
- Optional: notes/preferences (text)

Mentor profile

- Name, email
- Field(s) they can mentor
- University (optional)
- Capacity (e.g., max mentees)
- Status (available, unavailable)

Admin UI

- View students and mentors, matches, and profile information
- Search/filter lists by field/university/status

C) Matching workflow

Matching rules

- [filled out based on above comment response]

Admin flow (if match is non automatic)

- Admin selects a student → clicks "Find matches"
- App shows ranked mentors + "why" (e.g., "same field, same university")
- Admin confirms match

D) Session resources + weekly email automation

Automation

- A scheduled job runs daily (or weekly) and sends emails due in the next X days.

Likely tech stack:

- Frontend: React + TypeScript
- Backend: Firebase (Auth + Firestore) or Supabase
- Email: SendGrid/Mailgun/Resend (or Firebase Extensions)
- Scheduled emails: cron job (Vercel Cron / GitHub Actions / Supabase scheduled functions)